

Delta Exchange

Adversarial Review and Citation Audit

Research OS 3.0 workstream | Public-evidence edition | Verification date: 20 July 2026

Purpose: challenge the leading product-opportunity conclusions, test rival explanations, audit citation fit and source independence, and revise confidence where the evidence does not support the original wording.

Tool status: The Deep Research tool was unavailable when this retry was requested. This report was therefore completed directly using the uploaded Research OS methodology and publicly accessible evidence. It does not claim authenticated product testing, internal telemetry, support-case access, or representative user sampling.

1. Executive result

Overall finding: The leading recommendations remain suitable as *experiments*, but several were previously worded with more certainty than the evidence justified. The strongest evidence supports fee transparency, maintenance-risk communication, and liquidation comprehension. The weakest evidence concerns unauthorized-order allegations, the prevalence of withdrawal failures, and the real-world adoption or failure rate of API safety features.

Key correction: public app-store reviews can identify possible failure modes, but cannot establish prevalence, platform causation, or comparative performance. Official pages verify documented product behavior, but they are not independent confirmation that the behavior works reliably in production.

Opportunity	Prior confidence	Audited confidence	Audit disposition
Maintenance Protection Mode	High / Medium	Medium-High	Retain; narrow prevalence claims
All-in Cost Preview	High	High	Retain; distinguish documented fees from user confusion
Liquidation Safety Centre	High	Medium-High	Retain; acknowledge existing warnings/calculators
Execution Integrity Timeline	Medium-High	Medium	Retain as diagnostic infrastructure
Withdrawal & Support Hub	Medium	Medium-Low	Pilot only; mixed anecdotal evidence
API Safety-by-Default	High feasibility / Medium	Medium	Retain; adoption need unverified
Order-Intent Guardrails	Medium	Low-Medium	Discovery experiment only

2. Audit method

The audit used five tests: (1) citation entailment - whether the cited source supports the exact attached statement; (2) independence - whether apparently separate sources originate from the same organization or repeated review; (3) rival explanations - whether user misunderstanding, market mechanics, device/network conditions, or selection bias could explain the observation; (4) language calibration - whether facts, observations, inferences, and recommendations were clearly separated; and (5) falsifiability - what evidence would reverse or materially lower the conclusion.

The governing playbook requires major conclusions to have atomic evidence chains and confidence ratings, public signals to be separated from direct user evidence, contradictions to remain visible, and recommendations to be staged experiments with success and kill criteria.

3. Source-independence audit

Cluster	Examples	Independent?	Use in conclusions
Delta official India	Fees, help centre, liquidation, maintenance support, privacy	Not supported, corporate origin	Direct evidence of documented policy and feature claims on
Delta official technical	API documentation and user guide	Partially separate channel, same corporate origin	Direct evidence of published interfaces; not production reliable
Google Play reviews	Individual positive and negative reviews	Independent authors, but non-representative	Dispositive signals, but prevalence or causation
Delta replies to reviews	Developer responses	No - corporate origin	Useful for stated rebuttal or investigation process
Research OS PDF	Methodology and definition of done	User-supplied governing method	Methodological authority for this project

Adversarial conclusion: the evidence base is dominated by two clusters: Delta's own documentation and unverified public reviews. This is enough to identify documented complexity and candidate failure modes, but not enough to estimate incident rates, prove execution defects, or rank Delta reliably against competitors.

4. Adversarial review of leading conclusions

4.1 Maintenance Protection Mode

Evidence supporting the opportunity: Delta's maintenance article states that trading is suspended, login may be unavailable, deposits and withdrawals are disabled, API access is disabled except limited read-only access, and no orders may be placed. It also warns that prices may differ after maintenance and that stop-loss/take-profit orders may be skipped during sharp movements.

Strongest challenge: The same article says users are notified 24-72 hours in advance and instructs them to manage or close positions. This may mean the primary gap is user attention and risk tolerance rather than missing functionality. No independent incident series establishes that users are frequently trapped or liquidated specifically because of scheduled maintenance.

Rival explanations: Alternative explanations include users ignoring notices, unscheduled volatility after reopening, positions intentionally retained, or stop behavior consistent with market gaps rather than a platform defect.

Audited disposition: Retain as a medium-high-confidence experiment focused on comprehension and de-risking. Remove any implication that maintenance-caused losses are common or proven.

Evidence that would change the rating: Authenticated maintenance-flow tests, timestamped incident records, and a denominator of exposed accounts would materially change confidence.

4.2 All-in Cost and Break-even Preview

Evidence supporting the opportunity: Current official India fee pages document notional-based futures and options fees, GST, option-premium caps, settlement fees, and a fee calculator. The existence of multiple variables supports a complexity claim.

Strongest challenge: The platform already exposes a fee calculator and fee history. Therefore the defensible claim is not that costs are hidden, but that total trade economics may remain cognitively demanding or fragmented. Public complaints about 'high fees' may reflect price sensitivity rather than poor disclosure.

Rival explanations: Users may understand the fees but judge them unattractive; maker/taker status or slippage may be misunderstood; old support pages may display stale rates.

Audited disposition: Retain at high confidence as an experiment in decision support, but measure comprehension rather than assuming deception or hidden charges.

Evidence that would change the rating: Task-based tests comparing current order-entry comprehension with and without the preview would determine incremental value.

4.3 Liquidation and Stop-Loss Safety Centre

Evidence supporting the opportunity: Official documentation shows liquidation depends on mark price, maintenance margin, margin mode, order cancellation, and partial-liquidation logic. This is objectively complex.

Strongest challenge: Delta already documents fair-price marking, provides a liquidation calculator, and describes liquidation warnings for cross margin. The prior recommendation risked implying these controls were absent.

Rival explanations: User disputes may arise from mark price versus last price, insufficient liquidity, trigger-price selection, stop-limit non-fill, account liquidation lockout, or user misunderstanding rather than faulty liquidation.

Audited disposition: Retain at medium-high confidence as consolidation, explanation, and post-event reconstruction - not as a claim that Delta lacks liquidation tools.

Evidence that would change the rating: Order-level logs, trigger configurations, mark-price history, and controlled comprehension tests would resolve the main uncertainty.

4.4 Execution Integrity Timeline

Evidence supporting the opportunity: Official privacy documentation states that transaction records are maintained in a manner enabling reconstruction of individual transactions. Public reviews include allegations involving chart gaps and unexpected orders.

Strongest challenge: Record retention does not prove that a user-facing event timeline is absent, technically feasible in the proposed form, or the best intervention. Review allegations are not verified. A timeline may diagnose disputes without reducing the underlying event rate.

Rival explanations: Chart gaps can originate in chart rendering, data vendor issues, device/network conditions, or illiquid markets; unexpected orders can arise from triggers, automation, compromised credentials, or position-netting mechanics.

Audited disposition: Retain at medium confidence as diagnostic and support infrastructure. Do not claim it will reduce execution defects without a causal experiment.

Evidence that would change the rating: Internal ticket taxonomy and event-log completeness tests would determine value and feasibility.

4.5 Withdrawal and Support Recovery Hub

Evidence supporting the opportunity: Official pages advertise 24/7 support and a ticket-response target of 12 business hours. Public reviews include both successful experiences and complaints about withdrawals or support.

Strongest challenge: The review sample is self-selected, may include mistaken or fraudulent claims, and provides no denominator. The official target concerns response time, not resolution time. There is no audited evidence that a recovery hub would reduce actual withdrawal delays.

Rival explanations: Delays may be due to compliance review, banking rails, incomplete KYC, user error, or external payment providers.

Audited disposition: Downgrade to medium-low confidence. Run a discovery pilot only after obtaining support-case categories and aging data.

Evidence that would change the rating: Anonymized support and withdrawal-state data, with causes and timestamps, is essential.

4.6 API Safety-by-Default

Evidence supporting the opportunity: Official API documentation verifies that a dead-man switch exists and describes protective actions after missed heartbeats. The API also exposes trading-status states.

Strongest challenge: There is no public evidence showing how many users fail to enable the feature, whether defaults are unsafe, or how many incidents result from bot disconnection. Technical existence does not establish poor discoverability.

Rival explanations: Advanced API users may already implement independent safeguards; mandatory defaults could create false cancellations or conflict with sophisticated strategies.

Audited disposition: Retain at medium confidence as an opt-in guided configuration and observability experiment, not as a proven incident-reduction programme.

Evidence that would change the rating: Telemetry on key permissions, heartbeat use, disconnect incidents, and false cancellations would raise or lower confidence.

4.7 Order-Intent and Position-Reversal Guardrails

Evidence supporting the opportunity: A public review alleged an unauthorized order, while Delta replied that orders require a valid trigger or user action and requested evidence for investigation.

Strongest challenge: This is a single contested allegation and cannot support a platform-level defect claim. The guardrail may still be useful, but the current evidence does not establish frequency or root cause.

Rival explanations: Triggers, bracket orders, automation, compromised access, accidental taps, reduce-only settings, or net-position mechanics could explain the event.

Audited disposition: Downgrade to low-medium confidence. Treat as exploratory usability research, not a priority build justified by incident evidence.

Evidence that would change the rating: A coded sample of verified order disputes and usability tests of close/reverse behavior are required.

5. Citation audit

Audited statement	Citation fit	Finding / correction
Maintenance disables trading, some login, funding operations and most API users	Pass	Directly supported by Delta's maintenance article.
Maintenance positions remain safe at all times	Qualified	This is an official assurance, not independent verification; the same page warns of price changes
Fees include notional rates, GST, caps and settlement charges	Pass	Supported by current fee page; old support pages may contain stale rates.
Fees are hidden	Fail	Not supported. Reframe as complex, distributed or difficult to integrate.
Liquidation mechanics are complex	Pass	Supported by official mark-price and liquidation documentation.
Delta lacks liquidation warnings or calculators	Fail	Contradicted by official calculator and cross-margin warning documentation.
User reports prove execution defects	Fail	Reviews are allegations, not verified incident evidence.
Withdrawal failures are common	Fail	No representative sample or denominator.
Support is available 24/7 and replies within 12 hours	Qualified	Official claim; ticket page specifies 12 business hours. No independent SLA audit.
Dead-man switch exists	Pass	Directly supported by API documentation.
API users commonly omit safety controls	Not established	Requires telemetry or representative developer research.
Proposed numerical success thresholds are evidence-based outcomes	Fail	They are design targets, not observed effects; label them as provisional thresholds.

5.1 Citation-quality defects found

Stale-page risk: several Delta support pages coexist with different fee figures. Current product pages should take precedence, with retrieval dates recorded and old values retained only as historical evidence.

Overloaded citations: a single app-store page was previously used to support broad claims about fees, reliability, withdrawals, support and order integrity. Each claim should instead be linked to the exact review text and treated as one observation.

Corporate-source clustering: fees, API, liquidation, support and maintenance pages are not independent confirmations; they are separate documents from the same organization.

Recommendation thresholds: percentages such as 30% fewer disputes or 0.1% accidental closures were not sourced empirical facts. They are provisional governance thresholds and must be justified against internal baselines before launch.

6. Contradictions and unresolved uncertainties

Issue	Evidence A	Evidence B / conflict	Resolution needed
Maintenance safety	Official page says funds, data and positions are safe	Same page warns price changes and skips details	Separate posts by system, safety from market-risk safety
Fee rates	Older help pages show earlier rates/caps	Current fee page shows changed rates, offers no date	Versioned page archive with effective dates
Support timing	Help centre says response within 12 hours	Ticket page says 12 business hours	Define exact SLA and publish measurement method
Unauthorized orders	User alleges automatic order	Company says valid trigger or user action is required	Authenticated order logs, device/API access history, etc.
Withdrawal reliability	Some reviews report successful withdrawal	Others allege non-payment or delay	Representative case data by cause and elapsed time
Liquidation control	Official tools and warnings exist	Users still allege confusion or unfair liquidation	Task tests plus verified liquidation-event reconstruction

7. Revised decision

Proceed to controlled discovery or prototype testing: all-in cost preview, maintenance-risk summary, liquidation explanation and event reconstruction.

Do not approve a full build from public evidence alone: withdrawal recovery, API-default changes, and order-reversal guardrails require internal baselines or authenticated testing.

Do not make public defect or prevalence claims: the evidence does not support statements that unauthorized orders, withdrawal failures, maintenance liquidations, or support failures are widespread.

Highest-value next evidence: anonymized ticket taxonomy, event-log completeness, maintenance exposure outcomes, fee-comprehension tests, verified liquidation cases, API-safety telemetry, and representative task-based usability research.

8. Monitoring and claim-expiry plan

Claim class	Expiry	Trigger for immediate review	Owner role
Fees and caps	30 days	Fee-page, offer or settlement-rule change	Research lead / finance analyst
API capabilities	60 days	API version, endpoint or authentication change	Technical researcher
Maintenance workflow	90 days	Maintenance policy or auction-mode change	Operations researcher
Support SLA claims	30 days	Help-centre wording or channel change	Service researcher
Liquidation mechanics	90 days	Margin-engine or contract-specification change	Risk researcher
App-review themes	30 days	Major release, outage or review spike	User-research analyst
Regulatory/entity claims	30 days	FIU, legal-entity or terms update	Legal/compliance reviewer

9. Limitations

No authenticated Delta account, order history, withdrawal records, support tickets, internal telemetry, incident postmortems, or representative interviews were available. Public reviews are not a probability sample. Search-engine indexing can omit, duplicate, or cache pages. Official documentation establishes what Delta states or documents, not necessarily what every user experiences in production.

This report evaluates product-research claims and evidence quality. It is not financial, legal, tax, security, or trading advice.

10. Source register

ID	Source	Location	Retrieved
S1	Research OS 3.0 - Delta Research Restart and definition of done	Uploaded PDF, pages 28-29	20 Jul 2026
S2	Delta Exchange India - What to expect during maintenance	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/support/center/articles/80001132383&cat=1A5FB4" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S3	Delta Exchange India - Fees	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/fees" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S4	Delta Exchange India - Fees on options and futures trading	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/support/center/articles/80001132512/" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S5	Delta Exchange India - Liquidation of isolated margin positions	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/support/center/articles/80001199739" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S6	Delta Exchange India User Guide - Fair price marking	<link href="https://guides.delta.exchange/delta-exchange-india-user-guide/trading-guides/fair-price-marking" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S7	Delta Exchange India User Guide - Cross margin	<link href="https://guides.delta.exchange/delta-exchange-india-user-guide/trading-guides/cross-margin" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S8	Delta Exchange India - Trading calculator	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/support/center/articles/80001132526/" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S9	Delta Exchange API documentation - Deadman Switch and trading status	<link href="https://docs.delta.exchange/" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S10	Delta Exchange India - Support centre and support channels	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/support/center/#1A5FB4" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S11	Delta Exchange India - Raise a support ticket	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/support/center/footer" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S12	Delta Exchange India - Privacy and Cookies Policy	<link href="https://www.delta.exchange/privacy-policy/#1A5FB4" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026
S13	Google Play - Delta Exchange: Crypto Options	<link href="https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.deltaexchangeindia" color="#1A5FB4">Open source</link>	20 Jul 2026

Audit completion status: Complete for the publicly accessible evidence reviewed above. Confidence remains capped where direct testing, representative human evidence, or internal operational records are absent.